

Chapter 159-1

Gilded light and shadows overlapped and fell on the ground, falling into the crowd of people coming and going.

Xu Qingzhu sat on a bench in the hospital, holding the examination report, staring blankly.

She was pregnant.

Already over forty days along.

Coming to the hospital for a checkup had been a difficult decision. Xu Qingzhu had thought about it all afternoon in her office before making an appointment with this doctor.

She had deliberately avoided Zhao Xuning and also avoided Lin Luoxi.

The unfinished half of her sentence had eventually been slowly revealed under Lin Luoxi's curious gaze, shaking her head to deny Lin Luoxi's guess.

Yet she had anxiously made an appointment with a doctor for a checkup.

At the time, she had thought it was her period, but it turned out she had nearly had a miscarriage.

When she stopped bleeding afterward, she had thought it was because of too much stress causing her menstrual cycle to be irregular.

She hadn't thought to come to the hospital to get checked, and the result...

Counting the days, it should have been around when Liang Shi had just returned.

After Liang Shi temporarily marked her, both of their pheromones were very strong, so they had become intertwined in the confined space.

That was how it had happened.

This child seemed to have come at a very inconvenient time.

It was when their passion was at its peak, and there had been no plans for pregnancy, so they had gone wild in bed—and nearly caused a miscarriage.

...

The doctor said if she had come even one day later, the child wouldn't be in this condition anymore.

So now she had to rest and focus on protecting the pregnancy.

Xu Qingzhu sat there in a daze for a long time, until the setting sun sank and hid behind the mountains, the moon hung high, and all the lights in the city lit up in an instant, making this dim world bright.

Then she heard a nurse calling her name. "Xu Qingzhu."

Only then did Xu Qingzhu come back to her senses. She followed the nurse into the hospital room. The doctor first inserted a needle into Xu Qingzhu's wrist for an IV drip, then stood there giving instructions: "During this time, avoid spicy and greasy foods. Your morning sickness is quite severe, so try not to eat seafood—don't even smell fish or shrimp. But you need to keep up your nutrition. Drink some porridge every day—red dates and goji berries are best."

"Oh, right." The doctor suddenly asked. "Where's your partner?"

Xu Qingzhu was startled: "She's busy."

The doctor frowned: "You two were really too careless. The child almost didn't make it."

Xu Qingzhu pressed her lips together: "Sorry."

"Why are you apologizing to me?" The doctor had a hint of exasperation in her tone.¹ "The one you really owe an apology to is the child. You need to be very careful from now on, or there's a risk of miscarriage at any time."

Xu Qingzhu nodded: "I understand."

Seeing her being so well-behaved with a guilty expression on her face, the doctor didn't have the heart to say more. She comforted her with a few words: "But don't worry. Medical care in our country is very advanced now. We'll give you a few more injections of specialized medicine and you'll be fine. But remember what I said earlier. Also, remember this—absolutely no intercourse for three months."

"Mm-hmm." Xu Qingzhu agreed to everything.

The doctor stared at her but still couldn't help nagging: "During pregnancy, having a partner's companionship is definitely best, both for the mother and for the child. No matter how busy your partner is, she needs to make time to be with you. And your mood is clearly not good right now—your emotions have been fluctuating a lot recently. Try to maintain a happy state every day from now on."

"Okay." Xu Qingzhu said.

After instructing the nurse to cover her with a blanket, the doctor left. Xu Qingzhu gently closed her eyes, suddenly feeling drowsy. Before she could think much more, she drifted off to sleep.

1. The Chinese phrase "恨铁不成钢" (hèn tiě bù chéng gāng) literally means "to hate iron for not becoming steel." It describes the frustration felt when someone you care about fails to live up to their potential or makes careless mistakes. It's often used by elders or authority figures expressing exasperation mixed with concern. ←